SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

19 April 2021 · Shift 3

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 34 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 23 questions

Q.1

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. He often spread rumors that his neighbours were thieves. B. After being released, one of them sued him for wrongly accusing them. C. One evening, some of them were arrested by the police. D. After the investigation, they were proven innocent.

(A) ABCD
(B) ADBC
(C) DCAB
(D) ACDB

Q.2

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in the active or passive voice. Teachers should cover all the topics in the syllabus.

(A) All the topics in the syllabus should be covered by teachers.
(B) Teachers should be covered the syllabus in all the topics.
(C) Teachers should be covered all the topics in the syllabus.
(D) All the topics in the syllabus should cover teachers.

Q.3

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. The yoga instructor said to us, “Doing yoga daily will help you to develop a healthy mind and body."

(A) The yoga instructor said to us that daily yoga will help us to develop a healthy mind and body.
(B) The yoga instructor was told them that daily yoga would help them to develop a healthy mind and body.
(C) The yoga instructor said to us that doing daily yoga will be helping us to develop a healthy mind and body.
(D) The yoga instructor told us that doing yoga daily would help us to develop a healthy mind and body.

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution ’. My daughter could not find the words to say why she “has been crying” on a day when she should have been happy.

(A) can be crying
(B) is been crying
(C) No substitution
(D) was crying

Q.5

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) commitment
(B) development
(C) failier
(D) approval

Q.6

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. For each question, four _____ are given as options.

(A) alternates
(B) alternatives
(C) alterations
(D) altercations

Q.7

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, select the one that gives their correct order. A. I saw a middle-aged man sitting beneath the tree with his knees drawn up to his chest. B. When I was a street away from my house, I saw a huge banyan tree to my right. C. My heart went out to him as he was crying bitterly. D. His head was bowed and his body was shivering continuously.

(A) ADBC
(B) BADC
(C) ACDB
(D) BDCA

Q.8

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. the scientific study of the universe and planets

(A) astronomy
(B) astrology
(C) gemology
(D) physiology

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Severity

(A) Anguish
(B) Pain
(C) Seriousness
(D) Support

Q.10

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Eat or drink food quickly and in large amounts

(A) Choke
(B) Sip
(C) Gulp
(D) Swish

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. The green shirt is too “lose for me” to wear.

(A) lost for me
(B) loose for me
(C) No substitution required
(D) loss for me

Q.13

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A grey area

(A) An unclear situation
(B) A special part of the brain
(C) An unspoken truth
(D) An unusual spot

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To be in the dark

(A) to always be in a bad mood about darkness
(B) to learn to face dark places without fear
(C) to be afraid of darkness and refuse to go out at night
(D) to not know something others are aware of

Q.15

Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word. GRACEFUL

(A) dangerous
(B) attractive
(C) awkward
(D) pretty

Q.16

The following sentence has been divided into four segments. Select the segment that contains a grammatical error from the given options. I'm sorry, sir. / How many is / the fine for / returning the books late?

(A) I'm sorry, sir
(B) returning the books late
(C) How many is
(D) the fine for

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Constant

(A) Unchanging
(B) Competent
(C) Fluctuating
(D) Static

Q.18

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. EMERGE

(A) mingle
(B) withhold
(C) appear
(D) leave

Q.19

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. The children were warning not to try to climb the cliffs as they were very steep.

(A) were warning
(B) to climb
(C) as they were
(D) not to try

Q.20

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. During her vacation, Shanta _____ her mother when she went to work in the mall.

(A) accompanied
(B) isolated
(C) abandoned
(D) associated

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. These are the various symbols used on garbage bins. The wheeled-bin (1) _____ which is crossed out indicates that the item (2) _____ be disposed of separately from household waste. The item should be handed in for recycling (3) _____ to local environmental regulations for waste disposal. By (4) _____ a marked item from household waste, you will help reduce the volume of waste sent to landfills. It will also (5) _____ any potential negative impact on human health and the environment. For more information, please contact your nearest civic official.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) symbol
(B) photo
(C) item
(D) disposal

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. These are the various symbols used on garbage bins. The wheeled-bin (1) _____ which is crossed out indicates that the item (2) _____ be disposed of separately from household waste. The item should be handed in for recycling (3) _____ to local environmental regulations for waste disposal. By (4) _____ a marked item from household waste, you will help reduce the volume of waste sent to landfills. It will also (5) _____ any potential negative impact on human health and the environment. For more information, please contact your nearest civic official.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) proposed
(B) according
(C) subject
(D) accordance

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. These are the various symbols used on garbage bins. The wheeled-bin (1) _____ which is crossed out indicates that the item (2) _____ be disposed of separately from household waste. The item should be handed in for recycling (3) _____ to local environmental regulations for waste disposal. By (4) _____ a marked item from household waste, you will help reduce the volume of waste sent to landfills. It will also (5) _____ any potential negative impact on human health and the environment. For more information, please contact your nearest civic official.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) discarding
(B) separating
(C) throwing
(D) spoiling

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. These are the various symbols used on garbage bins. The wheeled-bin (1) _____ which is crossed out indicates that the item (2) _____ be disposed of separately from household waste. The item should be handed in for recycling (3) _____ to local environmental regulations for waste disposal. By (4) _____ a marked item from household waste, you will help reduce the volume of waste sent to landfills. It will also (5) _____ any potential negative impact on human health and the environment. For more information, please contact your nearest civic official.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) increase
(B) encourage
(C) minimise
(D) maximise

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.1

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term. JOKERS : NKOAVO : : ROMING : ?

(A) VKQERC
(B) VKQGRB
(C) WKQDRB
(D) VKRESC

Q.2

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Spoon : Feeding : : Microscope : ?

(A) Heating
(B) Radiating
(C) Grinding
(D) Magnifying

Q.4

Four options have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the option that is different.

(A) Eczema
(B) Psoriasis
(C) Scurvy
(D) Vitiligo

Q.5

Three of the following four numbers are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the number that is different from the rest.

(A) 2105
(B) 6457
(C) 4328
(D) 3124

Q.6

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 34, 39, 50, 67, 90, ?, 162

(A) 155
(B) 121
(C) 98
(D) 102

Q.7

In a certain code language, PAINT is written as QZHOU and BASK is written as CZTL. How will MOVIE be written in that language?

(A) LNWHF
(B) NNWHD
(C) NPWJD
(D) NNUHF

Q.8

If in a code language, ROHAN is coded as 3136 and SHYAM is coded as 4356, then how will you code RAM?

(A) 3412
(B) 2315
(C) 1234
(D) 1024

Q.9

What will be the value of the given expression if 'A' means '+', 'B' means '–', 'C' means '×' and 'D' means '÷'? 15 C 7 B (24 D 8) A 16 C 4 B 21 D 3

(A) 151
(B) 165
(C) 159
(D) 179

Q.10

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (11, 20, 81)

(A) (14, 29, 64)
(B) (12, 30, 224)
(C) (25, 36, 121)
(D) (36, 28, 25)

Q.11

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (1, 2, 6)

(A) (5 ,30, 930)
(B) (1, 2, 16)
(C) (10, 20, 40)
(D) (7, 14, 49)

Q.14

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some lights are wires. All appliances are lights. All bulbs are appliances. Conclusions: I. Some lights are appliances. II. Some wires are bulbs. III. All bulbs are lights.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(B) Both conclusions II and III follow.
(C) Only conclusion III follows.
(D) Both conclusions I and III follow.

Q.15

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. p r _ b n _ r q _ n p _ q b _ p _ q _ n

(A) q, p, b, r, r, n, n
(B) q, b, p, n, r, n, r
(C) q, r, n, p, b, r, n
(D) q, p, b, r, n, r, b

Q.16

Arrange the following words in a logical and meaningful order. 1. Eat 2. Rinse 3. Buy 4. Cut 5. Cook

(A) 1, 3, 5, 4, 2
(B) 2, 4, 3, 5, 1
(C) 3, 2, 4, 5, 1
(D) 4, 3, 5, 2, 1

Q.18

Which of the following four letter-clusters is different from the other letter-clusters?

(A) ILORUZ
(B) EGIKOT
(C) ABEGIJ
(D) ASOJIB

Q.20

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number. 54 : 81 : : 6 : ?

(A) 21
(B) 9
(C) 15
(D) 11

Q.21

U is the father of M. V is the wife of K. D is the mother of K's only brother M. How is U related to D?

(A) Brother
(B) Paternal uncle
(C) Father
(D) Husband

Q.23

There are three books coded as A, B and C. The price of book A is twice the price of book B and one-third the price of book C. If book C costs ₹84, then what are the costs of book A and book B, respectively?

(A) ₹14 and ₹42
(B) ₹24 and ₹42
(C) ₹14 and ₹7
(D) ₹28 and ₹14

Q.24

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term. Circle : Arc :: Flower : ?

(A) Smell
(B) Perfume
(C) Colour
(D) Petal

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which of the following is an input device?

(A) Speaker
(B) Scanner
(C) Projector
(D) Monitor

Q.2

Rafael Nadal won the Men's 2020 French Open title after beating:

(A) Daniil Medvedev
(B) Novak Djokovic
(C) Roger Federer
(D) Stefanos Tsitsipas

Q.3

As of the financial year 2018-19, which of the following is the largest raw jute producing state in India?

(A) West Bengal
(B) Nagaland
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Bihar

Q.4
Which filmmaker won the Best Screenplay award at the Venice film festival for 'The Disciple', a Marathi drama, in 2020?

(A) Arvind Deshpande
(B) Chaitanya Tamhane
(C) Sachin Kundalkar
(D) Hrishikesh Joshi

Q.5
What was the meaning of 'Ryot' in British records in the 18th century?

(A) Peasants
(B) Weavers
(C) Traders
(D) Jobbers

Q.6
Amarkantak plateau in Chhattisgarh contains an abundant deposit of which of the following minerals?

(A) Iron ore
(B) Mica
(C) Bauxite
(D) Coal

Q.7
Which of the following musical instruments is an example of the stringed instruments played by the Manganiars of west Rajasthan?

(A) Jhanj
(B) Kamaicha
(C) Manjira
(D) Toomba

Q.8
Who is the founder of the Grameen Bank of Bangladesh?

(A) Professor Muhammad Gawas
(B) Professor Muhammad Zaheer
(C) Professor Muhammad Shah
(D) Professor Muhammad Yunus

Q.9
Which Indian president used the pocket veto for the Indian Post Office (Amendment) Bill, 1986?

(A) APJ Abdul Kalam
(B) KR Narayanan
(C) Giani Zail Singh
(D) Dr Rajendra Prasad

Q.10
Who among the following kings founded the Maurya empire in ancient India?

(A) Dasaratha
(B) Ashoka
(C) Bindusara
(D) Chandragupta

Q.11
Who among the following is the ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha?

(A) President of India
(B) Vice-President of India
(C) Speaker of the Parliament
(D) Prime Minister

Q.12
A topology for a Local Area Network in which all nodes are individually connected to a central connection point like a hub or switch is called:

(A) star topology
(B) tree topology
(C) ring topology
(D) bus topology

Q.13
In which of the following states is the famous Chitradurga Fort located?

(A) Kerala
(B) Karnataka
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Rajasthan

Q.14
Which of the following movies won the ‘Best Tamil Film’ award at the 66th National Film Awards?

(A) Kaappaan
(B) Baaram
(C) Asuran
(D) Bhonga

Q.15
The 2018 edition of Commonwealth Games was hosted by:

(A) South Africa
(B) Canada
(C) Australia
(D) England

Q.16
Which of the following combinations of measures of quantity and unit is NOT a correct match?

(A) Weight - Cubic metre
(B) Temperature - Kelvin
(C) Pressure - Pascal
(D) Mass - Kilogram

Q.17
As of January 2021, how many Olympic medals did India win in the sport of badminton?

(A) Two
(B) Three
(C) One
(D) Five

Q.18
What is the importance of the ozone layer for life on Earth?

(A) It protects us from rainfall.
(B) It protects us from ultraviolet radiation.
(C) It protects us from snowfall.
(D) It protects us from acidic rainfall.

Q.19
Which country hosted the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Ministers meeting in October 2020?

(A) India
(B) China
(C) Japan
(D) Pakistan

Q.20
Primarily, an ant’s sting has which of the following?

(A) Tartaric acid
(B) Magnesium hydroxide
(C) Citric acid
(D) Formic acid

Q.21
Which of the following is NOT a plateau situated in India?

(A) Chota Nagpur
(B) Maikal
(C) Bundelkhand
(D) Malwa

Q.22
Which of the following is NOT an effect of an earthquake?

(A) Avalanche
(B) Tsunami
(C) Heavy rainfall
(D) Soil liquefaction

Q.23
Which of the following government schemes was launched with the objective of delivering government services to citizens electronically by improving online infrastructure and by increasing internet connectivity?

(A) Digital India
(B) Stand Up India
(C) AMRUT Plan
(D) Pradhan Mantri SVANidhi Scheme

Q.24

The International Conference on Nano Science and Nano Technology (ICONSAT) was held in March 2020 at:

(A) Kolkata
(B) Kozhikode
(C) Leh
(D) Shimla

Q.25

Which of the following organisations launched the 'United for Biodiversity' coalition made up of zoos, aquariums, botanical gardens, national parks, natural history and science museums from around the world, on World Wildlife Day 2020?

(A) World Wide Fund for Nature
(B) Commonwealth of Nations
(C) World Health Organization
(D) European Commission

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**
Q.16 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (D) ACDB

A says he called his neighbours thieves, C has some of them arrested, D has them proven innocent and B has one of them sue him after release: ACDB.

Q.2 · Answer (A) All the topics in the syllabus should be covered by teachers.

The passive of 'should cover' is 'should be covered', with the topics as subject: 'All the topics in the syllabus should be covered by teachers.'

Q.3 · Answer (D) The yoga instructor told us that doing yoga daily would help us to develop a healthy mind and body.

'Said to us' becomes 'told us', 'you' becomes 'us' and 'will' moves back to 'would': 'told us that doing yoga daily would help us to develop a healthy mind and body'.

Q.4 · Answer (D) was crying

The sentence is set in the past ('could not find'), so the reason is in the past too: 'why she was crying'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) failier

The correct spelling is 'failure'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) alternatives

'Alternatives' are choices to pick from; 'alterations' are changes and 'altercations' quarrels.

Q.7 · Answer (B) BADC

B brings in the banyan tree, A the man sitting beneath it, D describes him and C gives the narrator's response to his crying: BADC.

Q.8 · Answer (A) astronomy

Astronomy is the scientific study of the universe and the bodies in it; astrology claims the stars and planets influence human affairs.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Seriousness

'Severity' means seriousness or harshness.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Gulp

To 'gulp' is to swallow food or drink quickly and in large mouthfuls; to 'sip' is to drink in small amounts.

Q.12 · Answer (B) loose for me

'Loose' (not tight) is the adjective needed; 'lose' is a verb, to misplace or fail to win.

Q.13 · Answer (A) An unclear situation

A 'grey area' is a situation that is unclear, not clearly one thing or the other.

Q.14 · Answer (D) to not know something others are aware of

To 'be in the dark' about something is not to know about it while others do.

Q.15 · Answer (C) awkward

'Graceful' means smooth and elegant in movement; its opposite is 'awkward'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) How many is

A fine is an amount of money, asked about with 'how much': 'How much is the fine for returning the books late?'

Q.17 · Answer (C) Fluctuating

'Constant' means unchanging; its opposite is 'fluctuating', rising and falling. 'Unchanging' and 'static' are synonyms.

Q.18 · Answer (C) appear
To 'emerge' is to come out into view: to 'appear'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) were warning
The children received the warning, so the verb must be passive: 'The children were warned not to try to climb the cliffs'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) accompanied
To 'accompany' someone is to go somewhere with them: Shanta went along with her mother.

Q.21 · Answer (A) symbol
The passage is about the 'symbols' used on garbage bins; the crossed-out wheeled bin is one of them.

Q.23 · Answer (B) according
Recycling 'according to' local regulations; 'accordance' would need 'in accordance with'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) separating
'By separating' a marked item from household waste: keeping it apart, as the passage asks.

Q.25 · Answer (C) minimise
Separating such items will 'minimise', that is reduce, any harmful impact on health and the environment.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (A) VKQERC
The letters move +4 and −4 in turn: J → N, O → K, K → O, E → A, R → V, S → O. So ROMING → V K Q E R C: VKQERC.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Magnifying
A spoon is used for feeding, as a microscope is used for magnifying.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Scurvy
Eczema, psoriasis and vitiligo are skin disorders; scurvy is a disease caused by a lack of vitamin C.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 6457
In 2105, 4328 and 3124 the middle two digits are the product of the first and last: 2 × 5 = 10, 4 × 8 = 32 and 3 × 4 = 12. In 6457, 6 × 7 = 42, not 45.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 121
The differences are every other prime number: +5, +11, +17, +23, +31, +41 (skipping 7, 13, 19, 29 and 37). So 90 + 31 = 121, and 121 + 41 = 162.

Q.7 · Answer (B) NNWHD
Consonants move one place forward and vowels one place back: P → Q, A → Z, I → H, N → O, T → U. So MOVIE → NNWHD.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 1024
Each code is the square of the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet: ROHAN = 18 + 15 + 8 + 1 + 14 = 56 and $56^2 = 3136$; SHYAM = 66 and $66^2 = 4356$. RAM = 18 + 1 + 13 = 32 and $32^2 = 1024$.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 159
Replacing the letters: 15 × 7 − (24 ÷ 8) + 16 × 4 − 21 ÷ 3 = 105 − 3 + 64 − 7 = 159.

Q.10 · Answer (C) (25, 36, 121)
The third number is the square of the difference of the first two: $(20 - 11)^2 = 81$. Likewise $(36 - 25)^2 = 11^2 = 121$.

Q.11 · Answer (A) (5 ,30, 930)
Each number is the one before it times one more than itself: 1 × 2 = 2 and 2 × 3 = 6. Likewise 5 × 6 = 30 and 30 × 31 = 930.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Both conclusions I and III follow.
All appliances are lights, so some lights are appliances (I); all bulbs are appliances and all appliances are lights, so all bulbs are lights (III). Nothing links wires to bulbs, so II does not follow.

Q.15 · Answer (D) q, p, b, r, n, r, b
With q, p, b, r, n, r, b in the blanks the block prqbn repeats: prqbn prqbn prqbn prqbn.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 3, 2, 4, 5, 1
Food is bought, rinsed, cut, cooked and then eaten: 3, 2, 4, 5, 1.

Q.18 · Answer (D) ASOJIB
The letters of ILORUZ, EGIKOT and ABEGIJ are in alphabetical order; those of ASOJIB are not (after A they run backwards: S, O, J, I, B).

Q.20 · Answer (B) 9
The second number is one and a half times the first: 54 × 3/2 = 81. Likewise 6 × 3/2 = 9.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Husband
D is the mother of M and U is M's father, so U is D's husband.

Q.23 · Answer (D) ₹28 and ₹14
A costs one-third of ₹84, which is ₹28, and A is twice B, so B costs ₹14.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Petal
An arc is a part of a circle, as a petal is a part of a flower.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Scanner
A scanner feeds images and documents into a computer, so it is an input device; speakers, projectors and monitors are output devices.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Novak Djokovic
Nadal beat Novak Djokovic in the 2020 French Open final, played in October, for his 13th title at Roland Garros.

Q.3 · Answer (A) West Bengal
West Bengal is by far India's largest producer of raw jute, growing most of the country's crop.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Chaitanya Tamhane
Chaitanya Tamhane's 'The Disciple' won the Best Screenplay award at the 77th Venice International Film Festival in 2020.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Peasants
In British records 'ryot' meant a peasant cultivator; the Ryotwari settlement was made directly with these peasants.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Bauxite
NCERT names the Amarkantak plateau, the Maikal hills and the plateau region of Bilaspur-Katni as the main bauxite areas.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Kamaicha
The kamaicha, a bowed string instrument, is played by the Manganiar musicians of western Rajasthan; the jhanj and the manjira are cymbals.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Professor Muhammad Yunus
Muhammad Yunus founded the Grameen Bank, a pioneer of microcredit; he and the bank shared the 2006 Nobel Peace Prize.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Giani Zail Singh
In 1986 President Giani Zail Singh neither signed nor returned the Indian Post Office (Amendment) Bill, the best-known use of the pocket veto.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Chandragupta
Chandragupta Maurya founded the empire in about 321 BC; Bindusara, Ashoka and Dasaratha were later Mauryan kings.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Vice-President of India
Under Article 64 the Vice-President is the ex-officio Chairman of the Rajya Sabha.

Q.12 · Answer (A) star topology
In a star topology every node has its own link to a central hub or switch.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Karnataka
Chitradurga Fort stands in Chitradurga district of Karnataka.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Baaram
'Baaram', directed by Priya Krishnaswamy, won the award for Best Tamil Feature Film at the 66th National Film Awards (for 2018).

Q.15 · Answer (C) Australia
The 2018 Commonwealth Games were held at Gold Coast, Queensland, in Australia.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Weight - Cubic metre
Weight is a force, measured in newtons; the cubic metre is a unit of volume. Kelvin, pascal and kilogram are the SI units of temperature, pressure and mass.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Two
Saina Nehwal won bronze at London 2012 and PV Sindhu silver at Rio 2016; Sindhu's Tokyo bronze came later, in August 2021.

Q.18 · Answer (B) It protects us from ultraviolet radiation.
The ozone layer in the stratosphere absorbs most of the Sun's harmful ultraviolet radiation.

Q.19 · Answer (A) India
India, then chair of the SCO Council of Heads of Government, hosted the 7th meeting of the SCO Justice Ministers by video conference on 16 October 2020.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Formic acid
An ant's sting injects formic (methanoic) acid, which is what makes it burn.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Maikal
The Maikal is a range of hills, the eastern part of the Satpuras in Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh; Chota Nagpur, Bundelkhand and Malwa are plateaus.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Heavy rainfall
Earthquakes can set off avalanches, tsunamis and soil liquefaction; they do not bring rainfall.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Digital India
Digital India, launched in July 2015, aims to deliver government services electronically through better online infrastructure and internet connectivity.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Kolkata
ICONSAT 2020 was held at Kolkata on 5-7 March 2020, hosted by the S N Bose National Centre for Basic Sciences under the Department of Science and Technology's Nano Mission.

Q.25 · Answer (D) European Commission
The European Commission launched the 'United for Biodiversity' coalition on World Wildlife Day, 3 March 2020.

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